In the second half of the seventh century the school divided into the followers of ***Kumarila*** and ***Prabhakara***, the latter insisting that the *Vedic* injunctions (*vidhi*) incite action automatically, while the former hold that their motivating force is the prospect of rewards yielded by the rituals. Ritual performance keeps the cosmos going, provides benefits in this life and heavenly pleasures (*svarga*) for those who acquire sufficient merit. The developed tradition understands the soul as in itself an eternal spiritual essence that is embodied owing to ***karma*** and which really becomes involved in active life. The disinterested performance of ritual in a spirit of 'duty for duty's sake' effects a depersonalisation, culminating in release from rebirth once one's ***karma*** stock has been exhausted.

The *Vedic* statements are classified as action commands (*vidhi*), descriptions and explanations (*arthavada*), and incantations (*mantra*) to be used in the rituals. Since the ***Veda*** teaches what must be done in the ritual sphere, action commands are primary. *Arthavadas* are auxiliary statements that motivate the performance of actions commanded by *vidhis* by stating their rewards.

Further reading: Cowell and Gough 1996; Hiriyanna 1993; Jha 1964 and 1964

Purvavat: the inference of an effect from a cause. We may infer some future event on the basis of a present one, as when we predict rain from clouds.

R

Ramakantha Bhatta (950–1000 CE): principal philosopher of the dualistic and realistic Kashmiri ***Shaiva Siddhanta***